



University center Abdelhafid Boussouf - Mila
2019-2020 Semestre 1
E-Learning unit

English - level 1

– Lesson 9 – English quantifiers

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Institut	Département	Année	Spécialité
-Lettres et Langues étrangères	- Français	-Français	Licence 1
-Sciences et Techniques	-MI- ST	-MI- ST	Licence 1
-Sciences Economique	-SE	-Toutes les spécialités	Licence 1

Objectives of lesson 9

- i. To make students aware of the existence of quantifiers
- ii. To enable students use quantifiers appropriately

1. Definition:

A quantifier is a word or phrase which is used before a noun to indicate the amount or quantity. 'Some', 'many', 'a lot of' and 'a few' are examples of quantifiers.

Quantifiers can be used with both countable and uncountable nouns.

Examples:

*There are some books on the desk/

*He's got only a few dollars./

*How much money have you got?

<i>With Countable Nouns</i>	<i>With Uncountable Nouns</i>
• many • a few/few/very few • a number (of) • several • a large number of • a great number of • a majority of	• much • a little/little/very little • a bit (of) • a great deal of • a large amount of

few, a few, little, a little:

When we say '**a little**' or '**a few**', we mean a small amount, but it's enough:

- John: Let's go out tonight.
- Lucy: Okay. I have **a little** money, enough for the cinema at least.

On the other hand, '**little**' or '**few**' usually give us a different impression. These also mean a small amount, but this time the amount is almost nothing. If the noun is something that we want (like money or friends) then using 'little' or 'few' means that we don't have enough:

- John: Let's go out tonight.
- Lucy: Sorry, I have **little** money. I really can't afford to go out.

Some & Any

“Some and any” are determiners and they express an indefinite quantity or number. “Some and Any” are used when it is not easy, necessary or important to say exactly how many / how much we want to mean. They are both used with countable and uncountable nouns.

“**Some**” is often used in affirmative statements.

E.g.: There are some cherries in the basket. / There are some mistakes in the list.

“**Any**” is often used in negative sentences and questions.

E.g. there aren't any people on the moon. / Are there any doctors in your family?

Time for practice:

Fill in the blank with **a little / little / a few / few**

1. I have..... water left. There's enough to share.
2. I have..... good friends. I'm not lonely.
3. He has..... education. He can't read or write, and he can hardly count.
4. There are..... people she really trusts. It's a bit sad.
5. There is milk left in the fridge. It should be enough for our coffee.

References

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- 5) Chalker. S. (1992). A Student's English Grammar. Longman: England.
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